

DIGITAL DISTRIBUTION · VENDOR EVALUATION

eMagazines Platform Transition

Current state · Proposal analysis · Recommendation · Next steps

THE PROBLEM

Zinio costs **\$90K/yr** and generates **\$48K** in channel revenue. iTunes generates **\$109K/yr** and doesn't need Zinio at all.

01 / Current State

Zinio relationship economics — May 2025 through Apr 2026

ZINIO 12-MO INVOICE AVG

\$7,508/mo

12 months May 2025–Apr 2026

ZINIO CHANNEL REV AVG

\$3,995/mo

Store + Library only

STANDALONE ZINIO LOSS

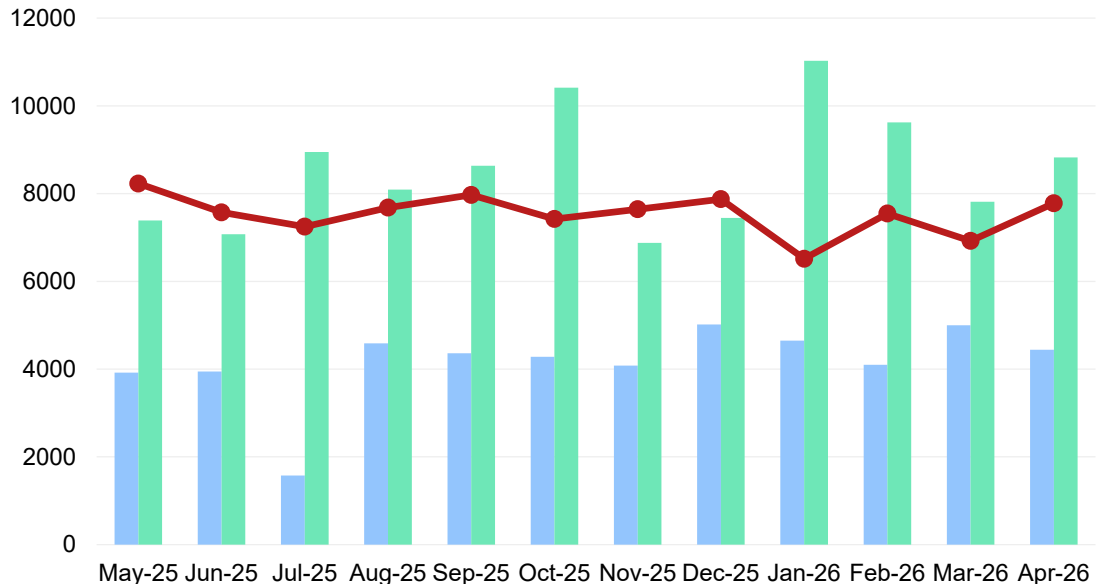
-\$3,511/mo

Channel rev cannot cover invoice

ITUNES AVG (SAME PERIOD)

\$8,165/mo

Flows through AIM App Store acct



The Zinio Problem

Zinio channel revenue has **never covered its own invoice** in any month with available billing data. iTunes/App Store revenue — tracked separately through AIM's own developer account is the hidden subsidy that makes the relationship viable.

2025 REVENUE BY CHANNEL

iTunes / App Store	\$109,529
Apple News+	\$16,372
Readly	\$20,678
EBSCO	\$17,562
Zinio (Store+Lib)	\$53,546
All other	\$28,089

02 / eMagazines Proposal

What they're offering · June 10, 2026 proposal · 60-day validity

WHAT EMAGAZINES PROVIDES

Digital Edition Platform

Mobile-optimized + replica editions, PWA, subscriber entitlement links, branded library, reporting

Apple News+ (ANF)

Full ANF production workflow and submission — currently a Zinio gap

Native iOS Apps (7 titles)

Branded apps for FW, FH, FG, Threads, Woodsmith, WD, Pop. Woodworking

3rd-Party Distribution

Handles EBSCO, B&N, Amazon — confirmed; Cengage TBD

Additional Programs

hoopla Digital (\$0.25/open) + eMags Unlimited (\$0.25/open) — incremental upside

FEE STRUCTURE

PLATFORM (PER BRAND/MONTH)

Platform hosting fee	\$100/brand/mo
iOS app hosting (≤12 issues/yr)	\$350/brand/mo
iOS app hosting (≤6 issues/yr)	\$300/brand/mo

PER ISSUE (PRODUCTION)

Mobile reflow + replica	\$350/issue
Replica only	\$150/issue
Apple News+ ANF coding	\$250/issue

PER SUBSCRIBER

Entitlement delivery link	\$0.025/delivery
---------------------------	------------------

ONE-TIME

Brand setup (most titles)	\$500
iOS app setup (each)	\$550
Back issue library (per brand)	\$250–\$750

eMagazines already active: 4 Textalk/CDP invoices at \$350–640/mo. Expansion, not cold start.

03 / Analysis & Recommendation

Cost delta · iTunes revenue preserved · Apple News+ opportunity · Recommendation

MONTHLY COST DELTA

Pro app fees eliminated	-\$2,700
Platform fee (17 titles)	+\$1,700
iOS app hosting (7 apps)	+\$200–550
Entitlement delivery (÷2)	-\$1,168
Issue conversion	~flat
Net monthly savings	~\$2,100
One-time migration (excl. back issues)	\$3,850–\$10,350
Payback period	1–5 months

ITUNES REVENUE — 7 APPS (FULLY PRESERVED)

Fine Woodworking	\$2,989/mo	Pop. Woodworking	\$555/mo
Fine Homebuilding	\$1,652/mo	Writer's Digest	\$419/mo
Fine Gardening	\$1,213/mo	Woodsmith	\$400/mo
Threads	\$937/mo		
Total: \$8,165/mo avg (Jan–Apr 2026) · Flows through AIM App Store acct — unaffected by vendor change			

APPLE NEWS+ EXPANSION OPPORTUNITY

Writer's Digest (not coded) 7 iss/yr	\$1,750/yr	\$100–250+/mo
Taunton 4 (FW/FH/FG/Threads) ~28 iss/yr	\$7,000/yr	\$400–700+/mo
WD + Taunton 4 (recommended) ~35 iss/yr	\$8,750/yr	\$500–950+/mo

Baseline: 7 titles live today generating \$16,372/yr (2025 actual)

RECOMMENDATION

- Transition all titles to eMagazines — digital edition fulfillment, ANF coding, iOS apps
- Retain 7 iOS apps on eMagazines platform — iTunes revenue (\$8,165/mo) fully preserved
- Exit Zinio entirely once migration is validated — no ongoing Zinio relationship required
- Expand ANF coding: WD + Taunton 4 as first tranche (~\$729/mo cost, \$500–950 upside)
- Defer back issue library until post-cutover — doesn't block migration

04 / Next Steps

Decisions required · Risks to resolve · Timeline

Immediate Decisions

Go / no-go on eMagazines

Proposal expires Aug 9, 2026. Decision needed to hold pricing.

ANF expansion scope

WD + Taunton 4 recommended as first tranche. Confirm titles and issue counts.

Zinio exit notice

Verify notice period in contract before committing migration timeline.

Cengage status

Confirm eMagazines can cover Cengage before finalizing scope.

Migration Workstreams

Subscriber entitlement continuity

Define handoff workflow for active Zinio subscribers → eMagazines delivery. Omeda integration required.

iOS app transition

7 apps · \$3,850 one-time · Subscriber restore-purchases on launch · Coordinate with Phil Graham on App Store access.

ANF onboarding

Provide eMagazines with PDF assets for new issue ANF coding. Define ongoing submission workflow.

Parallel run period

Overlap Zinio and eMagazines briefly to validate entitlement delivery before full cutover.

Open Items / Risks

Cengage contract verification

MEDIUM — must confirm coverage before external sharing.

Back issue library

MEDIUM — \$11K–\$14K one-time; deferrable. Doesn't block core migration.

ANF rev uplifts unproven

LOW-MED — estimates only; no direct comparables for new titles. Writer's Digest is lowest-risk test.

eMagazines app pricing premium

LOW — \$200–550/mo more than Zinio Pro for app hosting; offset by platform fee savings.

Appendix / Data Sources

All figures sourced from internal AIM reporting files

Zinio Invoices

zinioAllBillsPage.csv

MAY 2025 – APR 2026 (12 MONTHS)

Monthly invoice totals from AIM accounting system. Used for Zinio cost baseline and 12-month average (\$7,508/mo). Jan–Apr 2025 invoice data not available in this extract.

Apple News+ Revenue — Jan–Apr 2026

Apr26_Digital_Subs_Revenue_Jan__Apr_2026.xlsx

JAN – APR 2026

Per-title Apple News+ earnings (AppleNews sheet). 7 titles live: Popular Woodworking, Woodsmith, Garden Gate, Cuisine at Home, Old House Journal, Log & Timber Home Living, Horticulture. 2025 full-year total (\$16,372) from Dec-25 cumulative file; per-title 2025 breakout not available.

Digital Subscriptions Revenue — Monthly Cumulative Files

Digital_Subs_Revenue_Jan–[Month]_[Year].xlsx (10 files)

JAN 2025 – APR 2026

Cumulative YTD revenue by partner (Apple, AppleNews, Zinio, B&N, EBSCO, Google, Readly, Magzter, PressReader, Cengage). Individual months extracted by differencing adjacent cumulative files. Source for all channel revenue figures including Zinio Store+Library and Apple App Store totals.

Zinio Publisher Services Agreement

Publisher_Services_Agreement_v5_1__Active_Interest_Media_v4_03062023_signed.pdf
EXECUTED MAR 2023 · AMENDED APR 2024

Contract basis for Zinio fee structure: Appendix A conversion fees (\$60–\$150/issue by title), fulfillment delivery fees (\$0.05–\$0.10/delivery), Schedule B Pro app fees (\$200–\$400/title/mo). Amendment CAO Apr 25, 2024 on file.

Apple App Store Revenue — Jan–Apr 2026

Apr26_Digital_Subs_Revenue_Jan__Apr_2026.xlsx

JAN – APR 2026

Per-title iTunes/App Store earnings (Apple sheet). Used for 7-app revenue breakdown: FW, FH, FG, Threads, Pop. Woodworking, Writer's Digest, Woodsmith. Monthly avg \$8,165/mo across 4 months.

eMagazines Digital Solutions Proposal

eMagazines_Digital_Solutions_Proposal_AIM_20260610.pdf

DATED MAY 10, 2026 · VALID 60 DAYS (EXPIRES ~AUG 9, 2026)

Basis for all eMagazines pricing: platform fee \$100/brand/mo, iOS app hosting \$300–350/mo, issue production \$150–350, ANF coding \$250/issue, entitlement delivery \$0.025/link, app setup \$550 one-time, back issue library \$250–750/brand.

Marine titles (Sail, Soundings, PassageMaker, Yachts International, Anglers Journal, Power & Motoryacht) excluded from all figures.